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# The Vagus Re- set

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Companion Workbook — train your vagal tone in  
30 days

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

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# The Vagus Reset

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tone in 30 days

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HEALING HANDS BY NATE

## **The Vagus Reset**

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Continuity Member Edition — Month 4 Workbook

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Published by Healing Hands By Nate

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# Introduction

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A PRINTABLE COMPANION TO THE MONTH 4 MODULE. Train your vagal tone in 30 days.

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## CHAPTER 1

# How to use this workbook

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PRINT IT. PUT IT WHERE YOU'LL DO THE DAILY practice — bathroom mirror, kitchen counter, desk.

Vagal tone training is gradual. You won't see dramatic day-1 changes. You will see cumulative shifts by week 3 if you do the daily practice consistently. The workbook keeps you honest.

Bring it to your next session.

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## CHAPTER 2

# Where You Are Today — Vagal Tone Self- Assessment

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RATE SIGNS OF LOW VAGAL TONE (0 = NEVER, 10  
= **constant**):

Can't relax even when nothing's wrong

[\_\_\_\_]

Slow digestion / bloating after meals

[\_\_\_\_]

Startle easily

[\_\_\_\_]

Mentally racing when trying to sleep

[\_\_\_\_]

Shallow breathing without thinking

[\_\_\_\_]

Hoarse voice / frequent throat-clearing

[\_\_\_\_]

Cold hands and feet

[\_\_\_\_]

Slow recovery after exercise

[\_\_\_\_]

Sleep that doesn't feel restorative

[\_\_\_\_]

Wired but tired

[\_\_\_\_]

Difficulty taking a full deep breath

[\_\_\_\_]

**If you wear a smartwatch with HRV, today's HRV reading: \_\_\_\_\_**

**Three honest sentences about my stress recovery:**

1.

2.

3.

## CHAPTER 3

# Reflection Prompts

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**PROMPT 1:** WHEN SOMEONE HAS TOLD YOU TO “just relax” and it didn’t work, what was actually happening in your body? Did you feel angry, frustrated, more activated, helpless?

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**Prompt 2:** What’s the longest you’ve gone without feeling activated, alert, or “on” in the past month? When was the last time you felt truly rest-and-digest?

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**Prompt 3:** Of the three techniques (cold water, humming/gargling, slow exhale breathing), which one are you most drawn to? Which one feels most uncomfortable to try? Why?

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CHAPTER 4

# Pick Your Daily Practice

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## WHICH TECHNIQUE WILL I DO DAILY?

- ☐ Slow exhale breathing (4 in, 8 out, 10 breaths)
- ☐ Humming (5-10 sustained hums)
- ☐ Gargling (30 seconds, twice)
- ☐ Cold water on face (15-30 seconds submerged, OR 30 seconds splashing)
- ☐ Combination — primary technique: \_\_\_\_\_

**When in the day will I do it?** \_\_\_\_\_

**Where?** \_\_\_\_\_

**My acute-stress emergency technique** (when I need fast vagal activation):

- ☐ Cold water on face
  - ☐ Humming + slow exhale combined
  - ☐ 10 slow exhale breaths
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## CHAPTER 5

# 7-Day Vagus Practice Tracker

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FOR THE NEXT WEEK, DO YOUR DAILY PRACTICE and track what you notice.

### Daily check pattern

- Did I do the practice today? (Y/N)
- Duration / intensity
- Did I notice anything shift during or after?
- Stress / activation level at end of day (1 = calm, 10 = wired)
- Sleep onset tonight (minutes to fall asleep)

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Day 1 — Date: \_\_\_\_

Practice done? [☐] / Duration: \_\_\_\_ / Shift noticed? \_\_\_\_

End-of-day activation (1-10): [] / Min to fall asleep: \_\_\_\_

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Day 2 — Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Practice done? ☐ / Duration: \_\_\_\_ / Shift noticed? \_\_

End-of-day activation (1-10): [\_\_] / Min to fall asleep: \_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Day 3 — Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Practice done? ☐ / Duration: \_\_\_\_ / Shift noticed? \_\_

End-of-day activation (1-10): [\_\_] / Min to fall asleep: \_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Day 4 — Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Practice done? ☐ / Duration: \_\_\_\_ / Shift noticed? \_\_

End-of-day activation (1-10): [\_\_] / Min to fall asleep: \_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Day 5 — Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Practice done? ☐ / Duration: \_\_\_\_ / Shift noticed? \_\_

End-of-day activation (1-10): [\_\_] / Min to fall asleep: \_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Day 6 — Date: \_\_\_\_\_

**Practice done?** ☐ / **Duration:** \_\_\_\_ / **Shift noticed?** \_\_

**End-of-day activation (1-10):** [\_\_] / **Min to fall asleep:** \_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Day 7 — Date: \_\_\_\_\_

**Practice done?** ☐ / **Duration:** \_\_\_\_ / **Shift noticed?** \_\_

**End-of-day activation (1-10):** [\_\_] / **Min to fall asleep:** \_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_



## CHAPTER 6

# End-of-Week Reflection

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## RE-RATE SIGNS OF LOW VAGAL TONE (0-10):

Can't relax when nothing's wrong  
 [\_\_\_\_] (Day 1: [\_\_\_\_])  
 Mentally racing at bedtime  
 [\_\_\_\_] (Day 1: [\_\_\_\_])  
 Shallow breathing  
 [\_\_\_\_] (Day 1: [\_\_\_\_])  
 Sleep that doesn't feel restorative  
 [\_\_\_\_] (Day 1: [\_\_\_\_])  
 Wired but tired  
 [\_\_\_\_] (Day 1: [\_\_\_\_])

## What changed in 7 days?

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**Did I keep the daily practice?** [ Yes / Mostly / Sometimes / No ]

**Which technique worked best for me?**

- [ ] Slow exhale breathing
- [ ] Humming
- [ ] Gargling
- [ ] Cold water on face

**Did I use the acute-stress technique during the week? When?**

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**Recommitment for the next 3 weeks (to complete the 30-day commitment):**

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## CHAPTER 7

# Try this for 7 days

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IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK, try this:

**10 slow exhale breaths every morning before getting out of bed. Inhale 4, exhale 8. For one week.**

Just 10 breaths. Lying down. Before your feet hit the floor.

Most people notice their default daytime stress level drops within a week. This is one of the most leveraged 90 seconds of your day.

Bring this workbook to your next session.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,  
LMT and published by Healing Hands By  
Nate.